

Work Beyond Borders

From Ideas to Proposals: Practical Steps for Effective Project Design

July 2, 2026

Dun Concha Abiera
CEO, Work Beyond Borders





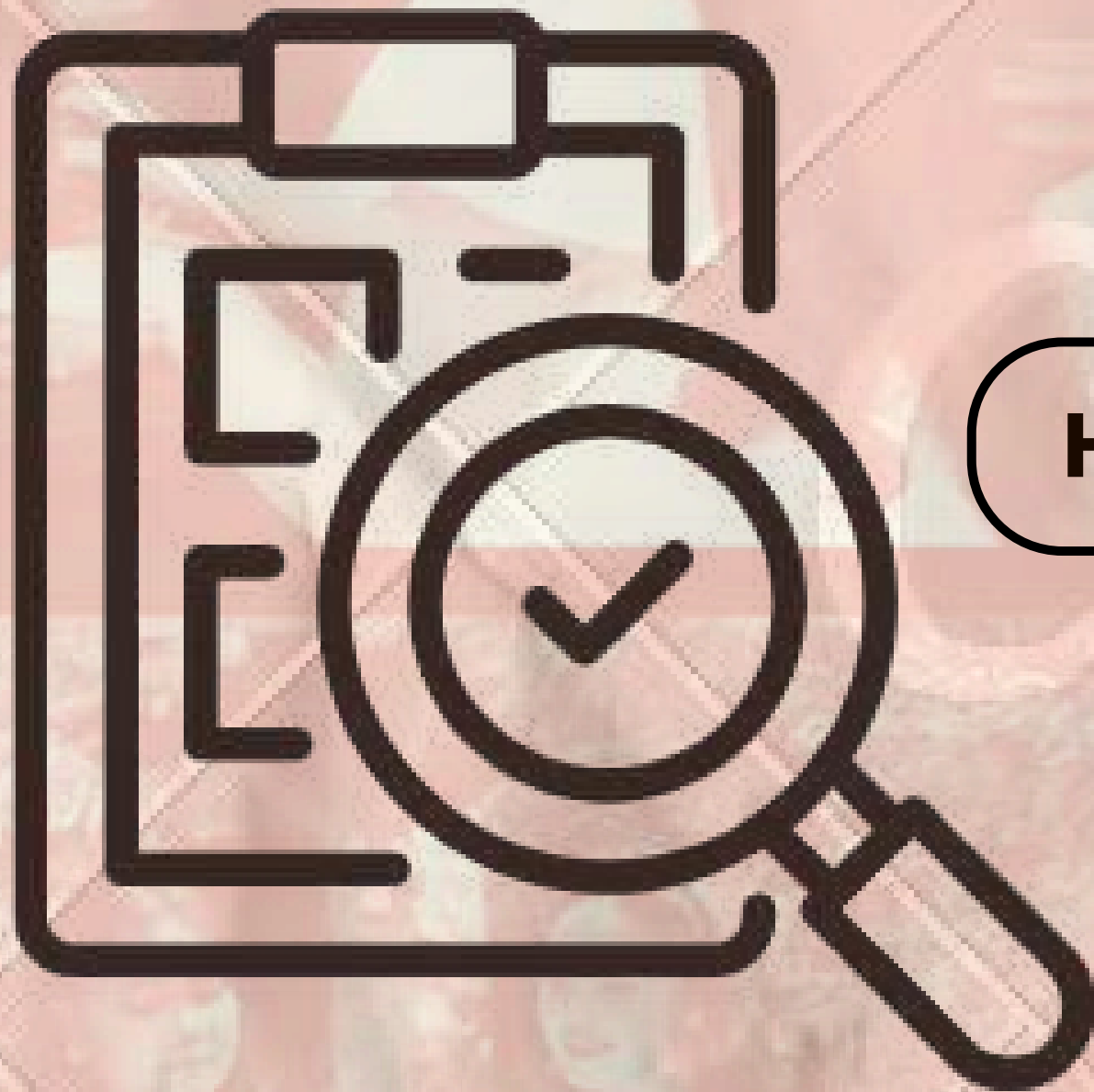
DUN CONCHA ABIERA



- 13 years of experience across the corporate and development sectors
- Earlier, founded YABONG, a youth-led non-profit organization
- Founder and CEO of Work Beyond Borders
- Specialist Representative on the Global Board of the UNESCO Media and Information Literacy Alliance



Work Beyond Borders



HOW TO PREPARE AND SUBMIT A PROJECT





Work Beyond Borders



BACKGROUND:

(Set the tone, build trust)

- Most of you already have something — an idea, a gut feeling, a thing that annoys you enough to want to fix it
- That's the starting line, not a problem
- You don't need a perfect concept, you just need momentum
- This session is not about who's the most brilliant, it's about who's brave enough to turn ideas into action
- Everyone starts messy, the pros are just people who kept going

**YOUTH HACKATHON
MENTORSHIP PROGRAM**



IDENTIFIED PROBLEM:

Why youth pitches fall flat

- Great ideas fail all the time not because they're wrong, but because they're not clear
- People try to say too much, or skip to the solution too fast
- If your listener can't repeat your project in one sentence, it's not ready
- Common killers: too vague, too technical, too long, too confusing
- Your pitch should feel like a lightbulb moment, not a puzzle



Work Beyond Borders

2

JUSTIFICATION:

Prove it's real

- Emotions are good but they're not enough
- A single fact can turn "nice" into "necessary"
- Don't overload people with stats, choose one that hits
- Make the problem undeniable in under 10 seconds
- Your idea should feel urgent like, "This needs to exist now"

YOUTH HACKATHON
MENTORSHIP PROGRAM



Work Beyond Borders

2

LOCALIZE THE PROBLEM:

Make it personal

- Avoid global generalizations. Zoom in on your street, your school, your circle
- The smaller your lens, the stronger your story
- People relate to what they recognize, not what they Google
- Speak like someone who lives it, not like a textbook
- The goal: audience hears your pitch and thinks, "That sounds like one of my problems too"

YOUTH HACKATHON
MENTORSHIP PROGRAM



Work Beyond Borders

2

PERSONALIZED DISCOVERY:

(Tell how the idea was born)

- Every pitch needs a heartbeat
- Tell us what triggered the idea (a moment, a conversation, a problem you couldn't unsee)
- Show how it moved from frustration → curiosity → action
- This part earns you trust and makes people believe you're serious
- If the audience feels it's your story, they're more likely to support the mission

YOUTH HACKATHON
MENTORSHIP PROGRAM



Work Beyond Borders

2

TRANSITION TO PROJECT BUILDING:

(Shift to structure)

- Once you've got people hooked, they need to know: "So what's the plan?"
- Don't get stuck in the problem, walk us into your solution
- This is the moment to switch gears: from story to strategy
- Your goal here: prove that the idea has legs, not just feelings
- Think of this as the "show-your-work" part of the pitch

YOUTH HACKATHON
MENTORSHIP PROGRAM



Work Beyond Borders

2

CRAFTING THE PITCH AND SUBMISSION:

Teach structure

- Use a pitch formula. It keeps things clean and strong
- You don't need to be flashy, you need to be clear
- Lead with clarity, land with impact
- Don't bury the gold, say the most important part first
- Write like you speak, cut the jargon

Must-haves in your pitch:

- **What's the idea**
- **What problem it solves**
- **Why it matters**
- **Who it helps**
- **How it works**
- **What you need (funds, mentors, tools, time)**



Work Beyond Borders

2

WRAP-UP & CALL TO ACTION:

End strong, inspire action

- Your pitch is just the start not the finish line
- You don't need to be chosen, you need to be ready
- Send the application. Submit the deck. Ask the question.
- No one's looking for perfection, people are looking for movement
- If you've made it this far, you're already ahead of most
- Don't wait for approval, build anyway

YOUTH HACKATHON
MENTORSHIP PROGRAM

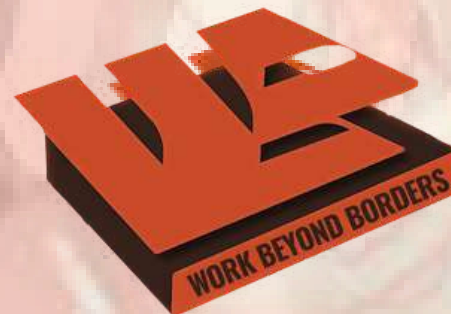
Let's Connect!



yabong.org



info@yabong.org



workbeyondborder.com



info@workbeyondborder.com



Dun Concha Abiera